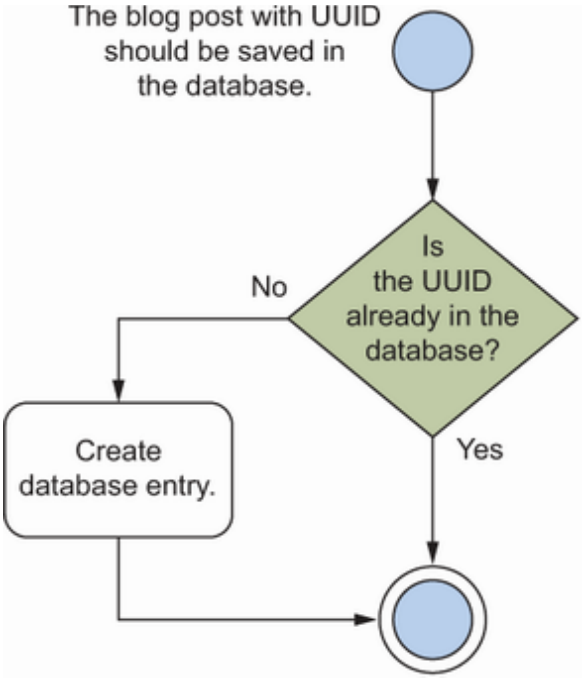


Figure 16.5 Idempotent database insert: Creating a blog post entry in the database only if it doesn’t already exist

Creating a blog post is a good example of an idempotent operation that is guaranteed by code. You can also use your database to handle this problem. Just send an insert to your database. The next three things could happen:

- Your database inserts the data. The operation is successfully completed.
- Your database responds with an error because the primary key is already in use. The operation is successfully completed.
- Your database responds with a different error. The operation crashes.

Think twice about the best way to implement idempotence!